Republic of the Philippines
Philippine Statistics Authority

# Registered Live Births in the Philippines, 2018

**Date of Release:** 27 December 2019
Reference No. 2019 - 230

***Explanatory Notes***

*Data on births presented in this release were obtained from the Certificates of Live Birth (Municipal Form No. 102) that were registered at the Office of the City/Municipal Civil Registrars all throughout the country and forwarded to the Philippine Statistics Authority. Information presented include registered births which occurred from January to December 2018. Cumulative figures for 2018 reflect updated data received from previous months and may differ from preliminary counts previously published. Births of Filipinos that occurred abroad which were reported to the Philippine Foreign Service Posts are presented in a separate report.*

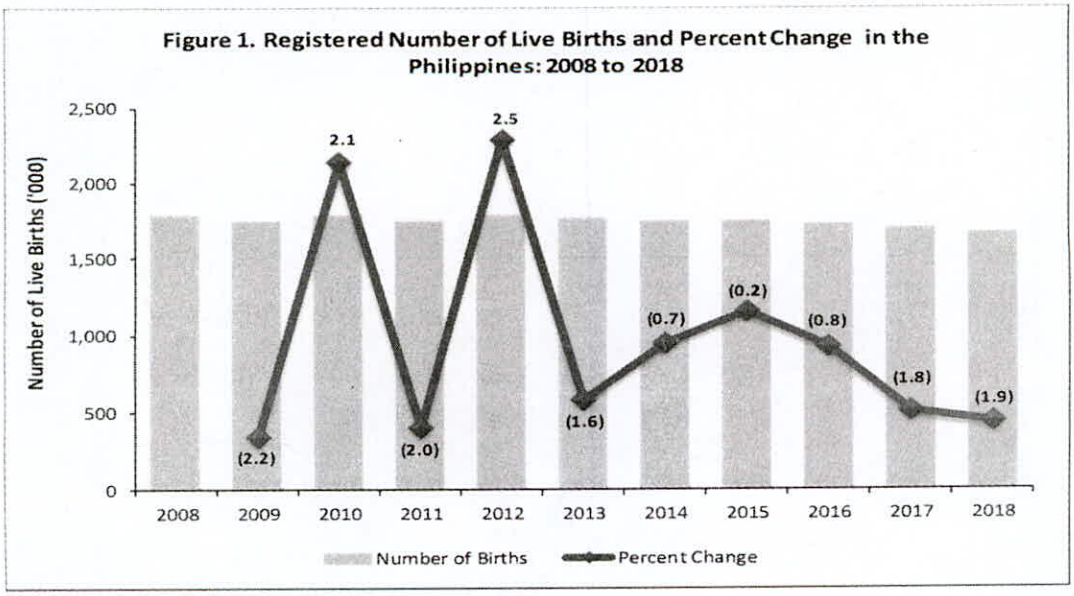
## Sixteen births per thousand population

In 2018, a total of 1,668,120 live births were registered, which is equivalent to a crude birth rate (CBR) of 15.8 or 16 births per thousand population.[1]

The number of registered live births showed a decreasing trend, noticeably from 2012 to 2018. The decrease in the last six years was 6.8 percent, from 1,790,367 live births in 2012 to 1,668,120 recorded births in 2018. (See Figure 1 and Table 1)

On the average, there were about 4,570 babies born daily or about 190 babies born per hour or approximately three babies born per minute.

**Figure 1. Registered Number of Live Births and Percent Change in the Philippines: 2008 to 2018**

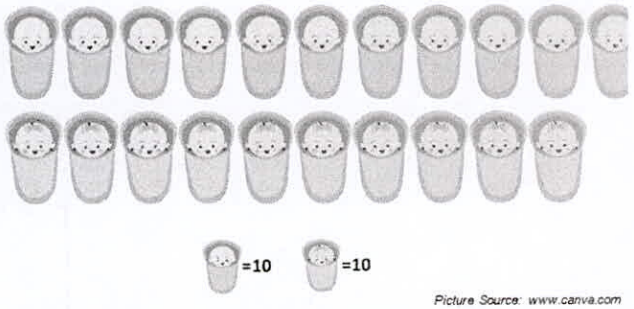



[1] Population estimate used was based on the 2015 census-based population projections available at www.psa.gov.ph/statistics/census/projected-population

## More males born than females

More males (870,832 or 52.2%) were born than females (797,288 or 47.8%), which resulted in a sex ratio at birth of 109 males per 100 females.
(See Figure 2 and Table 2)

Figure 2. Sex Ratio at Birth, Philippines: 2018

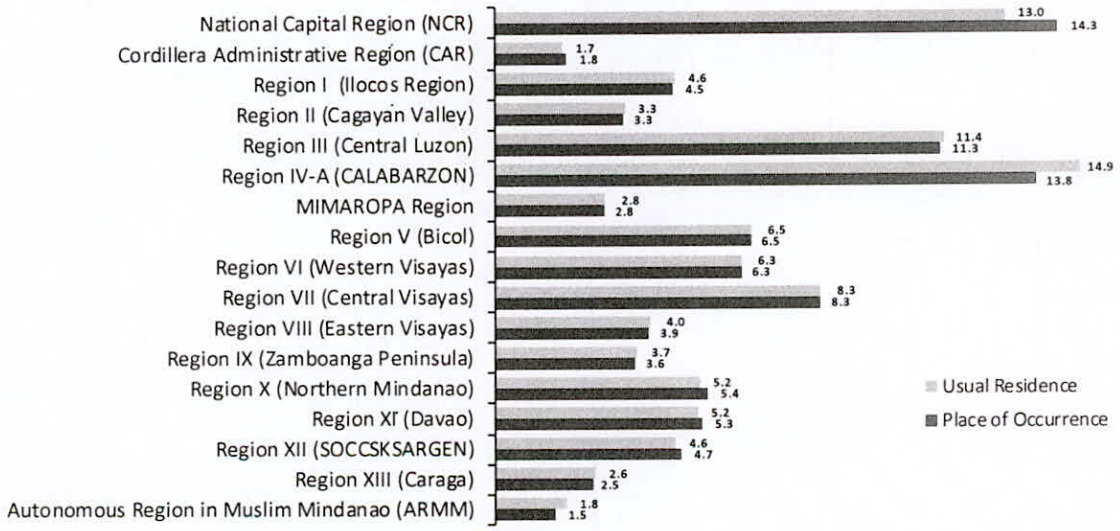



Picture Source: www.canva.com

## Highest occurrence of births in NCR

Of the total live births, 58.4 percent were born in Luzon, 18.5 percent in Visayas and 23.0 percent in Mindanao. Among the regions of the country, the National Capital Region (NCR) recorded the highest number of birth occurrences with 14.3 percent. Second in rank was CALABARZON (13.8%) and the third was Central Luzon (11.3%).
(See Figure 3 and Table 2)

Figure 3. Percent Distribution of Live Births by Place of Occurrence and by Usual Residence of Mother (Region) Philippines: 2018




Note: Numbers may not add up precisely to the total due to rounding.

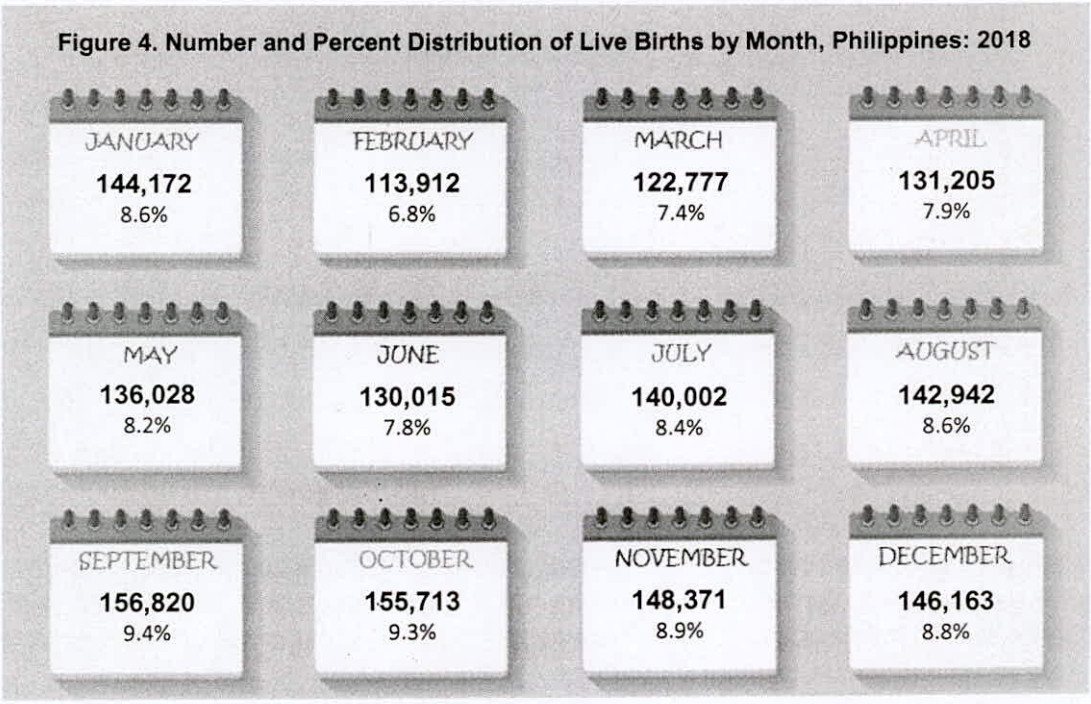
## More babies born outside the usual residence of the mother

The difference between the place of birth by occurrence and place of birth by usual residence of the mother by region is shown in the last column of Table 2. Five out of the 17 regions reported positive differentials in the number of births by place of occurrence. These positive differentials may be indicative of expectant mothers giving birth outside of their usual place of residence due to better health care facilities and social services in the receiving region. In Luzon, the receiving region was NCR which accounted for 22,210 births. Notably, expectant mothers from CALABARZON, Central Luzon and other areas in Luzon preferred to give birth in NCR.

## Most number of births in September

In 2018, most births occurred in September with 156,820 (9.4%) of the total births in the country. It was followed by the months of October (9.3%), November (8.9%), and December (8.8%). The month of February had the least number of births in 2018 (see Figure 4).

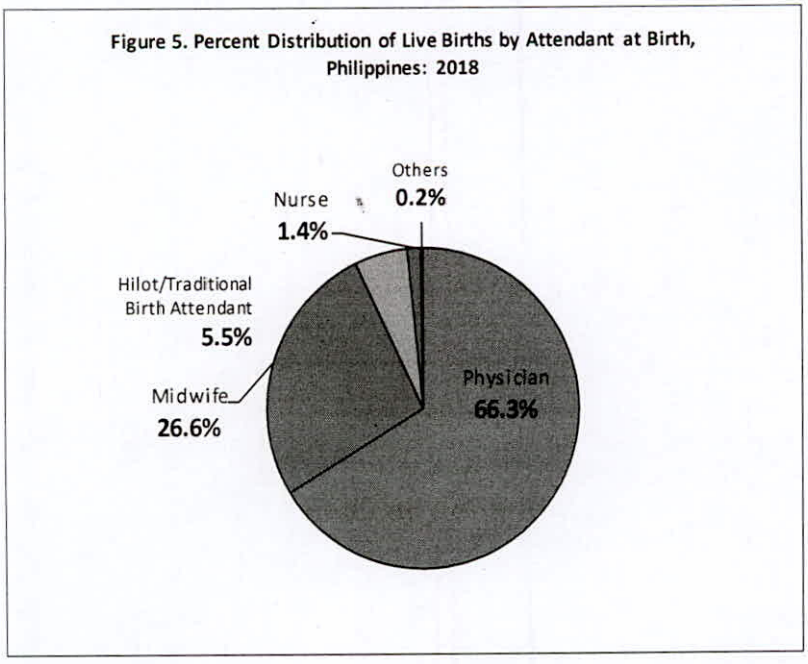
**Figure 4. Number and Percent Distribution of Live Births by Month, Philippines: 2018**




## Nine in ten birth deliveries are medically attended

Of the total number of births in the country, 94.3 percent birth deliveries were attended by health professionals which may either be a physician, a midwife or a nurse.
(See Figure 5, Tables 3a, 3b and 3c)

**Figure 5. Percent Distribution of Live Births by Attendant at Birth, Philippines: 2018**



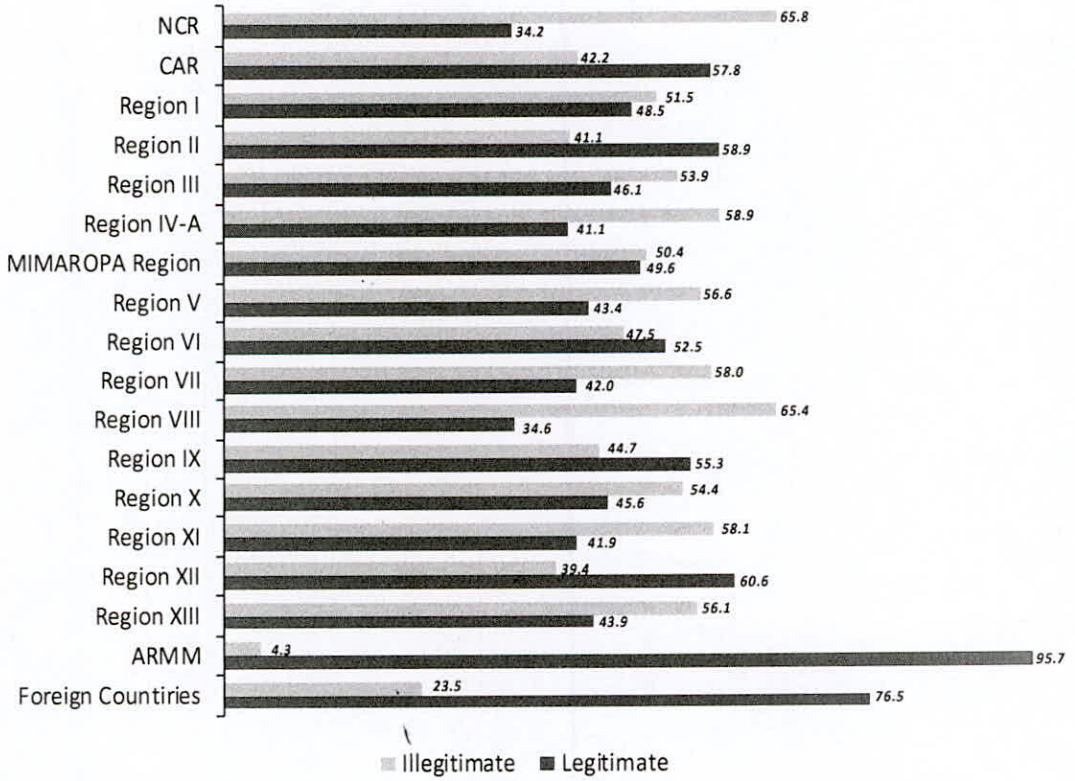
The number of births by place of occurrence and by usual residence of mother showed a remarkable proportion on births attended by health professionals in 16 regions. This is indicative of improving health services in terms of maternal and child health care. Among regions, only Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) showed a very low proportion of medically attended births. Almost half of the births that occurred in the region were attended by traditional birth attendants (hilot/unlicensed midwife). (See Tables 3a, 3b and 3c)

**More than half of babies born to unwed mothers**

More than half (906,106 or 54.3%) of the total registered live births in 2018 were born out of wedlock. The three regions that recorded the highest number of illegitimate children based on usual residence of the mother were CALABARZON (146,366), NCR (142,702), and Central Luzon (102,766). (See Figure 6 and Table 4)

The proportion of illegitimate babies in 11 regions of the country, were more than half of its total births. On the other hand, ARMM expectedly had the most number of legitimate births. The customs and traditions, rites and practices on marriage of Muslim communities has contributed to the high number of legitimate children in ARMM.

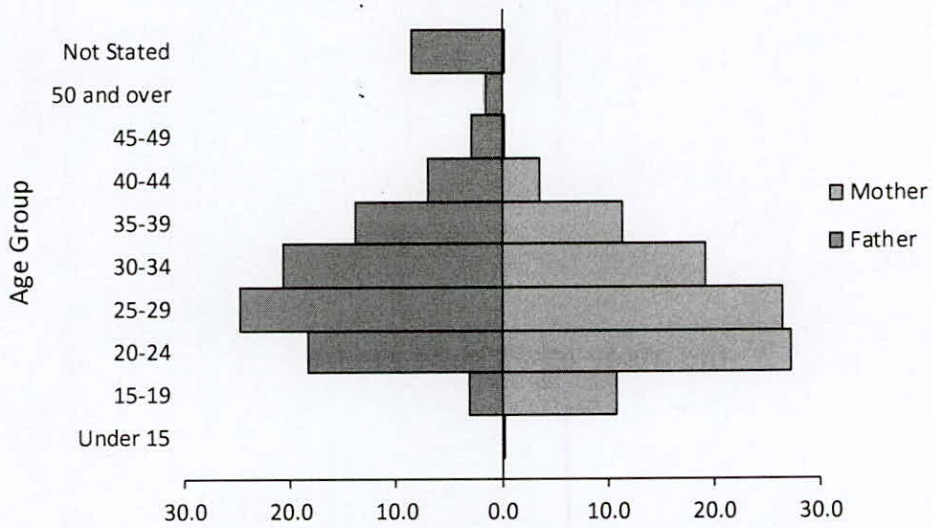
**Figure 6. Percent Distribution of Live Births by Legitimacy Status, and by Usual Residence of Mother (Region), Philippines: 2018**



**Majority of babies born to mothers aged 20-24 years old**

Majority of births were born to mothers aged 20-24 (454,648 or 27.3%) and to fathers aged 25-29 (411,606 or 24.7%). Moreover, babies born to adolescent mothers (183,967) were more than those babies sired by adolescent fathers (50,194). (See Figure 7 and Table 5)

**Figure 7. Percent Distribution of Live Births by Age Group of Father and Mother, Philippines: 2018**




The median age of mothers was 27 and for fathers was 29 years old. The median age of father excludes information from births where paternity is not acknowledged.

**CLAIRE DENNIS S. MAPA, Ph.D.**
Undersecretary
National Statistician and Civil Registrar General

Table 1. Number of Live Births and Percent Change, Philippines: 2008-2018

| | 2008 | 2009 | 2010 | 2011 | 2012 | 2013 | 2014 | 2015 | 2016 | 2017 | 2018 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Number | 1,784,316 | 1,745,584 | 1,782,981 | 1,746,684 | 1,790,367 | 1,761,602 | 1,748,857 | 1,744,767 | 1,731,289 | 1,700,618 | 1,668,120 |
| Percent Change | | (2.2) | 2.1 | (2.0) | 2.5 | (1.6) | (0.7) | (0.2) | (0.8) | (1.8) | (1.9) |
| Per Day | 4,875 | 4,782 | 4,885 | 4,785 | 4,892 | 4,826 | 4,791 | 4,780 | 4,730 | 4,659 | 4,570 |
| Percent change per day | | (1.9) | 2.1 | (2.0) | 2.2 | (1.3) | (0.7) | (0.2) | (1.0) | (1.5) | (1.9) |

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Civil Registration Service, Vital Statistics Division
Note: Figures are results of actual registration without any adjustment of under-registration.
Leap Years: 2008, 2012 and 2016

Table 2. Number of Live Births by Sex, by Place of Occurrence, and by Usual Residence of Mother (Region), Philippines: 2018

| Region | Number | | | | | | Percent | | Difference (Place of Occurrence Less Usual Residence of the Mother) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Place of Occurrence | | | Usual Residence | | | Place of Occurrence | Usual Residence | |
| | Both Sexes | Male | Female | Both Sexes | Male | Female | Both Sexes | | |
| Philippines | 1,668,120 | 870,832 | 797,288 | 1,668,120 | 870,832 | 797,288 | 100.0 | 100.0 | - |
| National Capital Region (NCR) | 239,081 | 125,136 | 113,945 | 216,871 | 113,301 | 103,570 | 14.3 | 13.0 | 22,210 |
| Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 30,722 | 16,046 | 14,676 | 29,123 | 15,228 | 13,895 | 1.8 | 1.7 | 1,599 |
| Region I (Ilocos Region) | 75,696 | 39,773 | 35,923 | 76,899 | 40,409 | 36,490 | 4.5 | 4.6 | (1,203) |
| Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 54,991 | 28,586 | 26,405 | 55,635 | 28,929 | 26,706 | 3.3 | 3.3 | (644) |
| Region III (Central Luzon) | 189,015 | 98,646 | 90,369 | 190,592 | 99,480 | 91,112 | 11.3 | 11.4 | (1,577) |
| Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 229,775 | 119,441 | 110,334 | 248,297 | 129,294 | 119,003 | 13.8 | 14.9 | (18,522) |
| MIMAROPA Region | 46,870 | 24,336 | 22,534 | 47,150 | 24,496 | 22,654 | 2.8 | 2.8 | (280) |
| Region V (Bicol) | 108,856 | 56,911 | 51,945 | 109,223 | 57,115 | 52,108 | 6.5 | 6.5 | (367) |
| Region VI (Western Visayas) | 104,838 | 54,470 | 50,368 | 104,976 | 54,525 | 50,451 | 6.3 | 6.3 | (138) |
| Region VII (Central Visayas) | 138,547 | 72,721 | 65,826 | 138,656 | 72,786 | 65,870 | 8.3 | 8.3 | (109) |
| Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 65,817 | 34,437 | 31,380 | 66,187 | 34,612 | 31,575 | 3.9 | 4.0 | (370) |
| Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 59,776 | 31,273 | 28,503 | 60,950 | 31,872 | 29,078 | 3.6 | 3.7 | (1,174) |
| Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 90,237 | 47,324 | 42,913 | 86,986 | 45,590 | 41,396 | 5.4 | 5.2 | 3,251 |
| Region XI (Davao) | 87,834 | 45,662 | 42,172 | 86,261 | 44,833 | 41,428 | 5.3 | 5.2 | 1,573 |
| Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 78,995 | 41,211 | 37,784 | 76,882 | 40,061 | 36,821 | 4.7 | 4.6 | 2,113 |
| Region XIII (Caraga) | 41,594 | 21,573 | 20,021 | 42,848 | 22,255 | 20,593 | 2.5 | 2.6 | (1,254) |
| Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) | 25,476 | 13,286 | 12,190 | 30,482 | 15,987 | 14,495 | 1.5 | 1.8 | (5,006) |
| Foreign Countries | - | - | - | 102 | 59 | 43 | * | * | (102) |

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Civil Registration Service, Vital Statistics Division
Note: Figures are results of actual registration without any adjustment of under-registration.
*Percentages are less than 0.1
- Counts are equal to 0

Table 3a. Number of Live Births by Type of Attendant, and by Place of Occurrence (Region), Philippines: 2018

| Place of Occurrence | Total | Type of Attendant | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Physician | Nurse | Midwife | Hilot/Traditional Birth Attendant | Others | Not Stated |
| Philippines | 1,668,120 | 1,105,967 | 23,334 | 444,211 | 91,540 | 3,054 | 14 |
| National Capital Region (NCR) | 239,081 | 183,984 | 550 | 48,293 | 6,103 | 151 | - |
| Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 30,722 | 26,935 | 482 | 2,343 | 438 | 524 | - |
| Region I (Ilocos Region) | 75,696 | 63,078 | 271 | 11,425 | 870 | 52 | - |
| Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 54,991 | 43,288 | 429 | 9,122 | 1,971 | 178 | 3 |
| Region III (Central Luzon) | 189,015 | 143,910 | 750 | 39,557 | 4,756 | 39 | 3 |
| Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 229,775 | 141,837 | 2,469 | 72,715 | 12,555 | 199 | - |
| MIMAROPA Region | 46,870 | 28,630 | 1,230 | 11,396 | 5,268 | 345 | 1 |
| Region V (Bicol) | 108,856 | 54,955 | 6,685 | 40,277 | 6,850 | 88 | 1 |
| Region VI (Western Visayas) | 104,838 | 70,256 | 823 | 27,566 | 5,866 | 324 | 3 |
| Region VII (Central Visayas) | 138,547 | 80,809 | 1,303 | 50,660 | 5,278 | 496 | 1 |
| Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 65,817 | 42,702 | 1,267 | 19,313 | 2,439 | 96 | - |
| Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 59,776 | 31,052 | 2,073 | 20,226 | 6,256 | 167 | 2 |
| Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 90,237 | 65,675 | 1,035 | 16,888 | 6,492 | 147 | - |
| Region XI (Davao) | 87,834 | 59,833 | 364 | 24,821 | 2,722 | 94 | - |
| Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 78,995 | 36,518 | 2,087 | 31,244 | 9,056 | 90 | - |
| Region XIII (Caraga) | 41,594 | 28,133 | 775 | 10,526 | 2,131 | 29 | - |
| Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) | 25,476 | 4,372 | 741 | 7,839 | 12,489 | 35 | - |

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Civil Registration Service, Vital Statistics Division
Note: Figures are results of actual registration without any adjustment of under-registration.
- Counts are equal to 0

Table 3b. Number of Live Births by Type of Attendant, and by Usual Residence of Mother (Region), Philippines: 2018

| Usual Residence of the Mother | Total | Type of Attendant | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Physician | Nurse | Midwife | Hilot/Traditional Birth Attendant | Others | Not Stated |
| Philippines | 1,668,120 | 1,105,967 | 23,334 | 444,211 | 91,540 | 3,054 | 14 |
| National Capital Region (NCR) | 216,871 | 162,391 | 536 | 47,784 | 6,030 | 130 | - |
| Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 29,123 | 25,344 | 470 | 2,349 | 444 | 516 | - |
| Region I (Ilocos Region) | 76,899 | 64,246 | 278 | 11,446 | 874 | 55 | - |
| Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 55,635 | 43,906 | 433 | 9,141 | 1,969 | 183 | 3 |
| Region III (Central Luzon) | 190,592 | 145,445 | 752 | 39,588 | 4,765 | 39 | 3 |
| Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 248,297 | 159,971 | 2,485 | 73,014 | 12,607 | 220 | - |
| MIMAROPA Region | 47,150 | 28,905 | 1,229 | 11,401 | 5,270 | 344 | 1 |
| Region V (Bicol) | 109,223 | 55,344 | 6,678 | 40,251 | 6,860 | 89 | 1 |
| Region VI (Western Visayas) | 104,976 | 70,366 | 818 | 27,601 | 5,864 | 324 | 3 |
| Region VII (Central Visayas) | 138,656 | 80,900 | 1,311 | 50,666 | 5,282 | 496 | 1 |
| Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 66,187 | 43,055 | 1,266 | 19,330 | 2,440 | 96 | - |
| Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 60,950 | 32,111 | 2,113 | 20,307 | 6,250 | 167 | 2 |
| Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 86,986 | 62,468 | 992 | 16,890 | 6,491 | 145 | - |
| Region XI (Davao) | 86,261 | 58,547 | 360 | 24,538 | 2,724 | 92 | - |
| Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 76,882 | 34,584 | 2,077 | 31,079 | 9,052 | 90 | - |
| Region XIII (Caraga) | 42,848 | 29,294 | 780 | 10,609 | 2,134 | 31 | - |
| Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) | 30,482 | 8,996 | 756 | 8,210 | 12,483 | 37 | - |
| Foreign Countries | 102 | 94 | - | 7 | 1 | - | - |

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Civil Registration Service, Vital Statistics Division

Note: Figures are results of actual registration without any adjustment of under-registration.

- Counts are equal to 0

Table 3c. Percent Distribution of Births by Place of Occurrence, by Usual Residence of Mother (Region), and by Attendant at Birth, Philippines: 2018

| Region | Number of Live Births | | Health Professionals | | Hilot/Traditional Birth Attendant | | Others | | Not Stated | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Place of Occurrence | Usual Residence | Place of Occurrence | Usual Residence | Place of Occurrence | Usual Residence | Place of Occurrence | Usual Residence | Place of Occurrence | Usual Residence |
| Philippines | 1,668,120 | 1,668,120 | 94.3 | 94.3 | 5.5 | 5.5 | 0.2 | 0.2 | * | * |
| National Capital Region (NCR) | 239,081 | 216,871 | 97.4 | 97.2 | 2.6 | 2.8 | 0.1 | 0.1 | - | - |
| Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 30,722 | 29,123 | 96.9 | 96.7 | 1.4 | 1.5 | 1.7 | 1.8 | - | - |
| Region I (Ilocos Region) | 75,696 | 76,899 | 98.8 | 98.8 | 1.1 | 1.1 | 0.1 | 0.1 | - | - |
| Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 54,991 | 55,635 | 96.1 | 96.1 | 3.6 | 3.5 | 0.3 | 0.3 | * | * |
| Region III (Central Luzon) | 189,015 | 190,592 | 97.5 | 97.5 | 2.5 | 2.5 | * | * | * | * |
| Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 229,775 | 248,297 | 94.4 | 94.8 | 5.5 | 5.1 | 0.1 | 0.1 | - | - |
| MIMAROPA Region | 46,870 | 47,150 | 88.0 | 88.1 | 11.2 | 11.2 | 0.7 | 0.7 | * | * |
| Region V (Bicol) | 108,856 | 109,223 | 93.6 | 93.6 | 6.3 | 6.3 | 0.1 | 0.1 | * | * |
| Region VI (Western Visayas) | 104,838 | 104,976 | 94.1 | 94.1 | 5.6 | 5.6 | 0.3 | 0.3 | * | * |
| Region VII (Central Visayas) | 138,547 | 138,656 | 95.8 | 95.8 | 3.8 | 3.8 | 0.4 | 0.4 | * | * |
| Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 65,817 | 66,187 | 96.1 | 96.2 | 3.7 | 3.7 | 0.1 | 0.1 | - | - |
| Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 59,776 | 60,950 | 89.3 | 89.5 | 10.5 | 10.3 | 0.3 | 0.3 | * | * |
| Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 90,237 | 86,986 | 92.6 | 92.4 | 7.2 | 7.5 | 0.2 | 0.2 | - | - |
| Region XI (Davao) | 87,834 | 86,261 | 96.8 | 96.7 | 3.1 | 3.2 | 0.1 | 0.1 | - | - |
| Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 78,995 | 76,882 | 88.4 | 88.1 | 11.5 | 11.8 | 0.1 | 0.1 | - | - |
| Region XIII (Caraga) | 41,594 | 42,848 | 94.8 | 94.9 | 5.1 | 5.0 | 0.1 | 0.1 | - | - |
| Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) | 25,476 | 30,482 | 50.8 | 58.9 | 49.0 | 41.0 | 0.1 | 0.1 | - | - |
| Foreign Countries | - | 102 | - | 99.0 | - | 1.0 | - | - | - | - |

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Civil Registration Service, Vital Statistics Division

Note: Figures are results of actual registration without any adjustment of under-registration.

* Percentages are less than 0.1

Table 4. Number and Percent Distribution of Live Births by Legitimacy Status, and by Usual Residence of Mother (Region), Philippines: 2018

| Usual Residence of Mother | Total | Legitimate | | Illegitimate | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Number | Percent | Number | Percent |
| Philippines | 1,668,120 | 762,014 | 45.7 | 906,106 | 54.3 |
| National Capital Region (NCR) | 216,871 | 74,169 | 34.2 | 142,702 | 65.8 |
| Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 29,123 | 16,823 | 57.8 | 12,300 | 42.2 |
| Region I (Ilocos Region) | 76,899 | 37,263 | 48.5 | 39,636 | 51.5 |
| Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 55,635 | 32,775 | 58.9 | 22,860 | 41.1 |
| Region III (Central Luzon) | 190,592 | 87,826 | 46.1 | 102,766 | 53.9 |
| Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 248,297 | 101,931 | 41.1 | 146,366 | 58.9 |
| MIMAROPA Region | 47,150 | 23,405 | 49.6 | 23,745 | 50.4 |
| Region V (Bicol) | 109,223 | 47,354 | 43.4 | 61,869 | 56.6 |
| Region VI (Western Visayas) | 104,976 | 55,074 | 52.5 | 49,902 | 47.5 |
| Region VII (Central Visayas) | 138,656 | 58,280 | 42.0 | 80,376 | 58.0 |
| Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 66,187 | 22,890 | 34.6 | 43,297 | 65.4 |
| Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 60,950 | 33,723 | 55.3 | 27,227 | 44.7 |
| Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 86,986 | 39,673 | 45.6 | 47,313 | 54.4 |
| Region XI (Davao) | 86,261 | 36,179 | 41.9 | 50,082 | 58.1 |
| Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 76,882 | 46,580 | 60.6 | 30,302 | 39.4 |
| Region XIII (Caraga) | 42,848 | 18,815 | 43.9 | 24,033 | 56.1 |
| Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) | 30,482 | 29,176 | 95.7 | 1,306 | 4.3 |
| Foreign Countries | 102 | 78 | 76.5 | 24 | 23.5 |

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Civil Registration Service, Vital Statistics Division

Note: Figures are results of actual registration without any adjustment of under-registration.

Table 5. Number and Percent Distribution of Live Births by Age Group of Father and Mother, Philippines: 2018

| Age Group | Number | | Percent | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Father | Mother | Father | Mother |
| Total | 1,668,120 | 1,668,120 | 100.0 | 100.0 |
| Under 15 | 64 | 2,250 | * | 0.1 |
| 15-19 | 50,130 | 181,717 | 3.0 | 10.9 |
| 20-24 | 306,203 | 454,648 | 18.4 | 27.3 |
| 25-29 | 411,606 | 443,365 | 24.7 | 26.6 |
| 30-34 | 343,170 | 322,554 | 20.6 | 19.3 |
| 35-39 | 228,720 | 192,250 | 13.7 | 11.5 |
| 40-44 | 114,747 | 61,420 | 6.9 | 3.7 |
| 45-49 | 47,118 | 5,797 | 2.8 | 0.3 |
| 50 and over | 25,633 | 215 | 1.5 | 0.0 |
| Not Stated | 140,729 | 3,904 | 8.4 | 0.2 |

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Civil Registration Service, Vital Statistics Division

Note: Figures are results of actual registration without any adjustment of under-registration.

*Percentage is less than 0.01